

TITLE: GLOBAL EMISSIONS POLICY BRIEF 2025

Focus: Analysis of Top Polluters & Sectoral Impact

1. EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Global CO2 emissions reached record highs in 2023.[3] While many developed nations are "decoupling" GDP growth from emissions, emerging economies are seeing rapid increases due to industrial expansion.[1]

2. THE TOP 5 POLLUTERS (2023 Data)

- **China:** World's largest absolute emitter (~30% share). Primary driver: Industrial manufacturing and coal-based energy.
- **USA:** Leading historical emitter. Highest per-capita emissions among major economies; transport is a massive contributor.
- **India:** Fastest growth rate (+6% YoY). Energy sector dominates as the country urbanizes.
- **EU-27:** Significant decline (-7.5% in 2023) due to aggressive renewable energy adoption.
- **Russia:** Large energy-sector footprint with high carbon intensity per GDP.

3. SECTORAL INSIGHTS

- **Energy:** Remains the largest source (>40%) globally. Transitioning to wind/solar is the #1 priority.
- **Transport:** Hardest sector to decarbonize. Policy must shift toward EV infrastructure and sustainable aviation fuel.
- **Industry:** Cement and steel production are "hard-to-abate." Carbon Capture and Storage (CCS) is critical here.

4. RECOMMENDATIONS

- **Standardize Carbon Pricing:** Implement "Carbon Border Adjustments" to prevent companies from moving pollution to unregulated countries.
 - **Target Transport:** Subsidize public transit and EV freight to lower the 20% contribution from transport.
 - **Equity:** High per-capita emitters (USA, Gulf States) must lead in financing the "Green Climate Fund" for developing nations.[1]
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